

Lesson 8 · Google AI Development Kit (ADK)

PDF: [this lesson](#) · **Install (Linux · macOS · Windows):** [guide](#) · [PDF](#)

Part of [local-ai-lab](#) — a hands-on course for building local AI.

Course home: <https://nikolareljin.github.io/local-ai-lab/> **Source:** <https://github.com/nikolareljin/local-ai-lab>

Lessons: [1 · RAG](#) → [2 · MCP](#) → [3 · LangChain](#) → [4 · LangGraph](#) → [5 · Ollama tools](#) → [6 · Semantic Kernel](#) → [7 · Bedrock Agents](#) → **8 · Google ADK (you are here)**

Status: planned. Outline below; full published slideshow lesson + step-by-step coming later. ADK **runs locally** (`adk run` / `adk web`) against Gemini. ☐ the repo to follow along.

The idea

Google's Agent Development Kit (ADK) is an open-source framework for building, evaluating, and deploying agents, designed around **Gemini** but model-agnostic. In this final lesson you rebuild the document agent with ADK and run it locally — closing the loop on "the same agent, six different ways."

What you'll learn

- **ADK agents** — defining an Agent with instructions, a model, and tools
- **Tools** — exposing a Python function (your `search_docs`) as an ADK tool
- **Sessions & runners** — running the agent locally with `adk run` (CLI) or `adk web` (dev UI)
- **Gemini integration** — using `gemini-2.5-flash`, plus how to point ADK at other models
- **Evaluation** — ADK's built-in eval harness for checking agent behavior

The design we'll build

```
from google.adk.agents import Agent
from localrag.config import load_config
from localrag.engine import get_retriever

def search_docs(query: str) -> str:
    """Search the user's local documents and return cited passages."""
    hits = get_retriever(load_config()).search(query, 5)
    return "\n\n".join(f"[{h['source']}]:{h['page number']} {h['text']}" for h in hits)

root_agent = Agent(
    name="docs_agent",
    model="gemini-2.5-flash",
    instruction="Answer from search_docs results and cite [source:page].\n\nIf it's not in the documents, say so.",
    tools=[search_docs],
)

# Run locally: adk run . (or) adk web
```

The finale: the `search_docs` function is, once again, Lesson 1's retriever. Across MCP, Ollama, Semantic Kernel, Bedrock, and ADK, the **capability** never changed — only the framework wrapping it. That's the whole point of the course: master the primitives, and every framework is just syntax.

Builds on

Concept	From
<code>search_docs</code> retriever tool	Lesson 1
function/tool calling	Lesson 5
agent frameworks compared	Lessons 3, 4, 6
ADK agents, tools, runners, eval	Lesson 8 (this one)

Prerequisites

Python, a Gemini API key (`GEMINI_API_KEY`), and `pip install google-adk`. [Lesson 1](#) provides the retriever the agent calls.

Course complete

You've built the same local-first document agent six ways — from a hand-rolled RAG pipeline up through MCP, local function calling, Semantic Kernel, Bedrock Agents, and ADK — and you understand every layer. Back to [the course home](#).

Course: nikolareljin.github.io/local-ai-lab · **Author:** [Nik Reljin](#)